



The Dakar was first held in 1979 across the unforgiving Sahara in Africa, but since 2009 it has run through South America. More than 400 cars, motorcycles, quad bikes, and trucks take part in each race, but fewer than 60 percent of these reach the finish line. This Mini is built tough and equipped with four-wheel drive, a powerful engine giving it a

111 mph (178 km/h) top speed, and tanks able to hold up to 106 gallons (400 liters) of gas. Driver Stéphane Peterhansel is a Dakar legend. He won the motorcycle class of the rally six times before switching to cars. Over two solid weeks of phenomenal off-road racing in his Mini, Peterhansel won the 2013 Dakar—his fifth victory in the car class.